

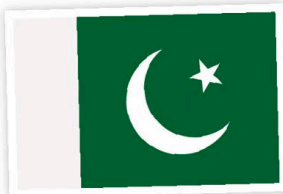
March

23

Born this day

1882 Amalie Emmy Noether, German mathematician. She made a big impact in algebra and physics with her work.

1983 Mo Farah, British-Somalian long-distance runner. He won four Olympic gold medals in the men's 5,000 m and 10,000 m.



1956

Islamic republic

Pakistan was proclaimed the world's first Islamic republic, following the Lahore Resolution of 1940, which proposed an independent state for Muslims. This date is now celebrated in Pakistan as Republic Day.

Also on this day

1983 US president Ronald Reagan announced the Strategic Defense Initiative, nicknamed "Star Wars", to protect the country against nuclear attacks.

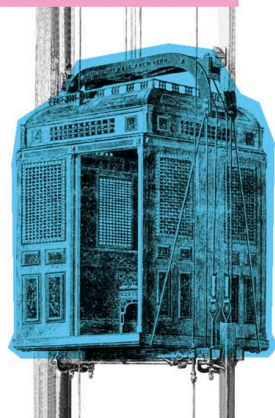
2003 The Japanese fantasy film *Spirited Away* became the first non-US animation film to win the Oscar for Best Animated Feature.

2014 The first cases of Ebola virus disease were reported by the World Health Organization (WHO) in Guinea. The epidemic caused at least 11,000 deaths in West Africa.

Going up!

The world's first lift opened to the public in the Haughwout department store in New York City, USA. Inventor Elisha Otis designed and installed this steam-powered invention to carry passengers up and down multiple floors safely.

1857



Sandstorm in Sochi

Fierce winds blew sand from the Sahara desert over the Mediterranean Sea and into Europe. The sand turned the snowy-white slopes of Sochi, Russia, bright orange, with media reports likening the landscape to the Red Planet, Mars.

2018

